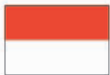


Indonesia



Formerly called the Dutch East Indies, Indonesia is the world's largest archipelago, with 18,108 islands scattered across 3000 miles (5000 km). It is the world's fourth most populous nation.



GEOGRAPHY

Indonesia is highly mountainous, with numerous tropical swamps. The land is covered with dense rainforest, especially on New Guinea, where it remains largely unexplored. There are more than 200 volcanoes, many of which are still active. Earthquakes, eruptions, and tsunamis are hazards. The islands of Java, Bali, Lombok, Sumatra, and Borneo were once joined together by dry land, which has since been submerged by rising sea levels. Coastal lowland development distinguishes some of the large islands.



CLIMATE

The climate is predominantly tropical monsoon. Variations relate mainly to differences in latitude and altitude; hilly areas are cooler overall. Rain falls throughout the year, often in thunderstorms, but there is a relatively dry season from June to September.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

The basic Melanesian–Malay ethnic division disguises a diverse society. Bahasa Indonesia, the national language, coexists with at least 250 other spoken languages or dialects. Attempts by the Javanese



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Republic of Indonesia

DATE OF FORMATION: 1949

CAPITAL: Jakarta

POPULATION: 230 million

TOTAL AREA: 741,096 sq. miles
(1,919,440 sq. km)

DENSITY: 332 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Javanese, Sundanese, Madurese, Bahasa Indonesia*, Dutch

RELIGIONS: Sunni Muslim 87%, Christian 9%, Hindu 2%, other 2%

ETHNIC MIX: Javanese 42%, other 31%, Sundanese 15%, coastal Malays 12%

GOVERNMENT: Presidential system

CURRENCY: Rupiah = 100 sen